



GDD 68

Navigating Addictions

Shame drives it underground; connection brings it to light.

A high-care Parent Layer pillar. It helps parents recognise and respond to a child or teen's dependence, on substances (alcohol, tobacco or vapes, drugs) or on screens, gaming and the phone. Its core insight: shame and punishment drive addiction underground, while calm, connection and the right help bring it into the open. Spot the signs, respond without rupture, treat it as a health issue, get help early, and look honestly at your own habits. Firmly non-shaming of child and parent; not medical advice. Seven mechanics, 28 choice-and-voice moments, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

Calm and connection, not shame.

Navigating Addictions helps parents recognise and respond to a child or teen's dependence, on substances (alcohol, tobacco or vapes, drugs) or on screens, gaming and the phone. Its core insight is that shame and punishment drive addiction underground, while calm, connection and the right help bring it into the open. It equips parents to spot signs, respond without rupture, treat dependence as a health issue rather than a moral failing, find professional help early, set healthy screen boundaries, and honestly look at the habits they model themselves. It is high-care and firmly non-shaming of both child and parent, provides no how-to for substances, treats acute risk as an emergency, and is not medical advice. New v2 build, the wellbeing spine carried into the realities of dependence.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g68 · navigating-addictions (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / layer	Chapter 8 · Parent Layer · adult / warm / high-care
Thread / topics	B · Parent Layer · Positive Parenting · UNESCO 5.1, 5.5, 5.6
Prerequisite / builds on	g67 · builds on g39 (Bounce) · connects g28 (Reality Check), g36 (Decoded)
Gating	Open · non-shaming; health-first; crisis-routed
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS the navigating-addictions game.

84

scenarios

7

mechanics

14

myth-flips

28

choice & voice

0%

binary taps

Shame drives it underground; connection brings it to light. Dependence can affect any child, and it's not a verdict on them or your parenting. Harsh crackdowns, threats and humiliation make a struggling child hide; calm concern, an open door, and being firm about the behaviour while unconditionally there for the child keep them reachable. Addiction is a treatable health condition, not weak willpower or a moral failing, and recovery is real with help. Get help early, model honest habits yourself, and treat any acute danger, like a possible overdose, as an emergency.

Protect the kids; find support; no shame.

From the Chapter 8 personas (parenthood). Parents facing a rising risk amid heavy stigma, the persona note: navigate addiction in the family, protect the kids, find support, no shame. They need to spot it, respond without rupture, and reach real help.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Any worried parent	To spot the signs and respond calmly.	sort + role-play : spot, respond.
Vikram (the discovery)	To stay connected, not explode.	branch + role-play : don't rupture.
Divya (seeking help)	Where to turn, early and shame-free.	match + role-play : get the right help.
Kamla & Priya	Screen limits and honest modelling.	strike-rewrite + sort : screens & modelling.

Why this works (the evidence). Dependence can affect any child and is not a verdict; substance and behavioural dependence are both real, gaming disorder is recognised in the WHO ICD-11, and the warning signs are loss of control, escalation and disruption of life, best read with calm and the whole picture rather than panic or surveillance. Shame and punishment drive it underground while calm connection keeps a child reachable, and addiction is a treatable health condition, not weak willpower, so recovery is real with support. Early professional help with family involvement works (family-inclusive approaches markedly outperform child-only ones), parents model habits, and any acute risk is an emergency.

Seven moves, led by the flip and the words.

It's a respond-with-care game, so **strike-rewrite** leads (busting the crackdown-and-shame myths) with **branch** for the stay-connected choices and **role-play** for the calm words that keep a child reachable; **sort** tells signs from noise. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE PARENT DOES	EMBODIES	N
strike-rewrite signature	Busts a shame-or-crackdown myth.	Conceptual change.	14
branch (the choice)	Chooses calm connection over rupture.	Judgement.	14
role-play (voice)	Says the calm, connecting, help-seeking words.	Voice; connection.	14
sort	Sorts sign vs ordinary; open vs slam; helps vs harms.	The line.	13
match	Pairs an instinct to a connecting response; a need to a route.	Connections.	10
reflect	Internalises reach-not-catch and health-not-disgrace.	Values.	10
spot	Spots the calm read, the reachable response, the real help.	Reading it.	9

28 of 84 moments are branch or role-play. Binary "tap the right answer": **0%**.

The two-test, passed.

Is it engaging?

Game feel is steadiness and hope for a frightened parent: the relief of 'it's not a verdict on us', the power of a calm response that keeps a child talking, and the clarity of knowing dependence is treatable and where to turn. The "I can stay connected and still hold a limit" moment lands repeatedly. Sam is a warm adult guide; the tone is high-care and firmly non-shaming of child and parent, never moralising, never how-to, and clear that any acute danger is an emergency.

Is it teaching?

Yes: recognising warning signs of substance and screen or gaming dependence; responding calmly without shaming or rupturing the relationship; accessing the right help early (counselling, de-addiction services); setting healthy screen boundaries; reflecting on the habits a parent models; and treating acute risk as an emergency.

The belief it moves. From "a good kid wouldn't; crack down and punish; shame them straight; it's just weak willpower; if strong they'd stop; treatment doesn't work; handle it secretly; my habits don't matter" → "it can affect any child; connection beats fear; shame drives it under; it's a treatable health issue; recovery is real; help works; involve professionals; and your own habits are part of the picture."

Built, not bolted on.

84 researched scenarios across the spot-the-signs → respond-don't-rupture → it's-a-health-issue → get-the-right-help → screens-and-modelling → tools-and-safety arc, India-grounded, high-care and warm. Full library in the companion JSON.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
Spot the signs	14	strike-rewrite, sort, role-play	Typical vs concerning; calm noticing, not snooping.
Respond, don't rupture	14	strike-rewrite, branch, role-play	Calm, connected responses; firm and there at once.
It's a health issue	14	strike-rewrite, sort, role-play	Treatable, not a moral failing; recovery is real.
Get the right help	14	strike-rewrite, role-play, match	Counselling & de-addiction, early; family involved.
Screens & modelling	14	strike-rewrite, sort, role-play	Agreed limits; your own habits matter too.
Tools & safety	14	branch, role-play, match	Help-finder; acute risk is an emergency.

The 'crack down' flip + the 'moral failing' flip, verbatim.

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flip: "The way to stop it is to crack down hard, punish and threaten."
UN -> "Crack down hard, punish and threaten."
RE -> "Harsh crackdowns and threats usually drive it underground; calm,
      connected responses keep a child reachable and willing to get help."

flip: "Addiction is just weak willpower or a moral failing."
UN -> "Addiction is just weak willpower or a moral failing."
RE -> "Addiction is a treatable health condition involving the brain,
      genes and environment, not simply weakness or bad character."
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Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 68 Navigating Addictions — Scenario Library.json](#) (84 records, v2 schema).

What this game flips.

MYTH (UN ERASES)	TRUTH (RE WRITES)	BASIS
A good kid would never get hooked.	Dependence can affect any child; it's not a verdict.	Any kid.
The way to stop it is to crack down and threaten.	Crackdowns drive it underground; connection keeps them reachable.	Connection over fear.
Shaming will scare them straight.	Shame drives dependence underground and deepens it.	Shame drives it under.
Addiction is just weak willpower or a moral failing.	It's a treatable health condition, not weakness or bad character.	Health, not weakness.
If they were strong enough, they'd just stop.	Dependence changes the brain; it's about help, not strength.	Not about strength.
Treatment doesn't work; once an addict, always.	Recovery is real and common with support.	Recovery is real.
Handle it secretly, tell no professional.	Professional help works best, alongside family.	Get help.
My own habits have nothing to do with my child.	Kids learn by watching; model honestly.	Model honestly.

The micro-loop.

1. **Surface.** A real moment, a worrying change, a discovery, a relapse, a shaming relative, a parent's own habit.
2. **Choose or voice.** The parent chooses calm connection over rupture (branch), or finds the calm words (role-play).
3. **The flip.** UN busts a shame-or-crackdown myth; RE writes the calm, health-first truth.
4. **Connect & help.** Stay reachable, treat it as health, get help early, set fair limits, model honestly.
5. **Safety.** Any acute danger, like a possible overdose, is an emergency to route at once (112, a hospital, Childline 1098).
6. **Sticker.** The Navigating Addictions badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surface: the **respond-don't-rupture** moment and the **health-not-disgrace** reframe. It carries Bounce (g39) into the realities of dependence, connects to the screen-literacy thread (Reality Check g28, Decoded g36), and sits with the positive-parenting pillars (g65-g69).

Non-shaming, help-first, crisis-routed.

- **Firmly non-shaming.** Of both child and parent: it busts the practice and the stigma, never the person, and frames dependence as a health issue, not a moral failure.
- **Connection over control.** Calm, connected responses are taught as more protective than surveillance, threats or cutting off the bond.
- **Health-first, help-first.** It signposts real help, counselling, de-addiction centres, Tele-MANAS 14416 and Childline 1098, and stresses getting help early.
- **Acute risk is an emergency.** A possible overdose or any immediate danger is routed at once to emergency medical help (112, a hospital).
- **No how-to; not medical advice.** It never provides instructions for obtaining or using substances, and points to professionals for assessment and treatment.
- **Privacy & review.** Private by design (DPDP-aligned), on-device, expert-reviewed; the parent's own habits are met with the same compassion.

It's a health issue, and help works (India). Dependence, on substances or screens, is treatable, not a disgrace or a moral failing, and shame only drives it deeper. Respond with calm and connection, and get help early: Tele-MANAS 14416, Childline 1098, or a de-addiction counsellor. If there is any acute danger, a possible overdose, or your child is in immediate danger, treat it as an emergency, emergency 112 or the nearest hospital, right away. This is support, not medical advice.

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. navigating-addictions** equals node.game equals GameDone key equals registry id (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema.** type + typed payload; the **strike-rewrite** shame-myth flip and the **branch** stay-connected choice co-lead.
- **High-care is a hard requirement.** Non-shaming of child and parent, connection-over-control, health-first, acute-risk-as-emergency, no-how-to and not-medical-advice are contractual; expert-reviewed.
- **Fact-checked content.** Addiction-as-treatable-health-condition, ICD-11 gaming disorder, and family-inclusive treatment outperforming child-only verified this build.
- **Scorecard-gated.** Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, top mechanic at 17%, 0% binary, 28 autonomy, 14 UN→RE, 5 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run score_gdd.py on any edit.
- **Help-resource hook.** Support routes via the shared component (Tele-MANAS 14416 / Childline 1098 / de-addiction services); acute risk to emergency 112.
- **Tracked.** build_gate.py finalize advances g68 to v2 PASS only after order, read, score, audit and artifact gates pass.

Ethics contracts (never traded for engagement): firmly non-shaming of child and parent; connection over control; health-first and help-first; acute risk is an emergency; no how-to for substances; not medical advice; made-for-India.

Why this works.

- **Shame drives it under, so lead with connection.** Because harsh, shaming responses make a child hide while calm connection keeps them reachable, teaching parents to respond without rupture genuinely keeps a struggling child safer.
- **It's a treatable health issue, so reframe it.** Since addiction is a treatable condition and not a moral failing, and recovery is real, framing it as health and getting help early gives a child the best chance.
- **Family involvement works, so equip parents.** Because family-inclusive help markedly outperforms child-only approaches, equipping calm, connected, involved parents, and routing acute risk to emergency care, is what protects children.

Sources: UNESCO ITGSE Key Concept 5 (skills, decision-making and help-seeking); WHO on adolescent health and behavioural addictions, with gaming disorder recognised in the ICD-11; the evidence that addiction is a treatable, chronic health condition involving the brain, genetics and environment rather than weak willpower or a moral failing, with real recovery; family-based adolescent-treatment research showing family-inclusive approaches markedly outperform child-only ones; and India support routes, Tele-MANAS 14416, Childline 1098, and de-addiction services, with emergency 112 for acute danger. High-care and firmly non-shaming of both child and parent, connection over control, providing no how-to for substances, and not medical advice. Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 68 games now v2. Next by order: Be the Safe Adult (g69).